

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Explosions & nearby shelling

CONFLICT / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move away from windows and exposed areas into the most protective intact shelter you can reach safely. Stay clear of damaged buildings and unfamiliar debris. Keep family members together and shoes, a light and medicines close. A pause in explosions is not an all-clear; do not go out to film, investigate or collect fragments.

Do now.

- ☐ **Get out of exposed space**
01 Use a designated protective shelter if it is safely reachable. Otherwise choose the most protective intact interior space available, away from glazing. Consider fire, collapse, flooding and escape access; a basement is not safe if these hazards are present.
- ☐ **Protect yourself from secondary hazards**
02 Keep away from windows, loose masonry and damaged electrical equipment. Keep footwear on when moving. Do not use a lift in a damaged building.
- ☐ **Check people without increasing exposure**
03 Account for the household from shelter. Provide first aid only where you will not become another casualty. Send a brief private status message if service is available.
- ☐ **Reassess the building**
04 Smoke, fire, instability or flooding may require movement to a safer reachable place. Do not interpret a quiet period as proof that streets or unexploded objects are safe.
- ☐ **Keep debris untouched**
05 Never handle suspicious fragments, wires, containers or munitions. Keep children and pets away. Do not approach to take a photograph.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If broadcasts and emergency numbers fail, keep sheltering while it remains intact and safer than movement. Check essential supplies, agree on short check-ins and use trusted neighbours without sending people into exposed areas.

Watch for.

No ordinary room is guaranteed protection against weapons. Do not travel through active fighting or assume a claimed safe corridor has been secured.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group

Next decision.

Prepare for loss of water, power and communications. Choose a reunion contact and a second shelter option. Use recently verified humanitarian or local information to judge whether movement is safer than staying.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

ICRC · Urban warfare and civilian protection

ICRC · Find help

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/explosions-shelling/>